EMBROIDERY BUSINESS STARTUP CHECKLIST

The whole starting sequence in order: paperwork, equipment, craft, pricing, customers. Print it, work it top to bottom, check them off as you go.

Start lean. Earn the upgrades with job revenue, not with hope.

PAPERWORK

- [ ] Business name chosen and checked with the state
- [ ] Legal structure decided and registered
- [ ] EIN from the IRS (free)
- [ ] Separate bank account opened
- [ ] Sales tax requirements checked for my state
- [ ] A way to take payment set up

EQUIPMENT AND SUPPLIES

- [ ] Machine I can already run, serviced and working
- [ ] Hoops in the sizes I will actually sell
- [ ] Stabilizer assortment (cutaway + tearaway)
- [ ] Thread set, spare needles, snips
- [ ] Practice blanks (cheap tees, totes)

THE RULE ON PAPERWORK

If you are unsure about the legal or tax side, ask an accountant, not a Facebook group. One paid hour early beats a penalty letter later. This checklist is the common pattern for one person shops, not legal advice.

CRAFT AND PRICING

- [ ] 20+ practice pieces stitched
- [ ] Pricing method set up from my true costs
- [ ] Written policies: deposits, rush, minimums

CUSTOMERS

- [ ] First 3 customers lined up (charge properly)
- [ ] One clear offer written down
- [ ] Photos of finished work ready to show
- [ ] Order tracking in place from job one

TWO PRICING RULES FROM DAY ONE

- [ ] **Never price below true cost.** Not for family, not for exposure, not for a first review. Below cost is not a discount, it is a donation.
- [ ] **Charge digitizing on the first order.** It is real work, or a real bill from a digitizer. Spread it across bulk runs, drop it on reorders.